Construction Site Safety: Scaffold Safety

Training document for the SafeSite Assistant RAG exercise

Important note: This is fictional training material prepared for software testing and learning. It is not official regulatory guidance. Verify legal requirements against the applicable jurisdiction and competent safety advice.

1. Purpose and scope

This sample covers basic scaffold planning, inspection, access, loading, and fall-prevention practices. It is educational material and does not replace local regulations or a competent person's inspection.

2. Erection and inspection

Scaffolds should be erected, altered, and dismantled by trained and authorized personnel according to the design and manufacturer's instructions where applicable.

Before first use, after significant alteration, and after events that could affect stability, a competent person should inspect the scaffold and record findings as required by site rules and applicable law.

Check that the scaffold is founded on a stable base, adequately braced, properly tied where required, and fitted with suitable platforms and access. Do not use a scaffold with missing components or visible damage until it has been assessed and made safe.

3. Guardrails and platforms

Provide suitable guardrails, intermediate rails, toe boards, or equivalent protection where required to prevent falls and falling objects. Exact legal specifications, including threshold heights, depend on the jurisdiction and scaffold configuration.

Keep platforms fully decked as required for the design, secure boards against displacement, and avoid gaps that create trip or fall hazards. Do not exceed the scaffold's rated load.

Keep platforms tidy. Store materials so that they do not obstruct access or create unstable stacks, and secure tools or materials where they could fall onto people below.

4. Safe access and use

Use the designated ladder, stair tower, or other approved access system. Do not climb cross-bracing unless the scaffold design and approved procedure explicitly permit it.

Do not move a mobile scaffold while people or unsecured materials remain on it unless a specific approved procedure allows the operation. Follow the manufacturer's instructions and site rules.

Stop using the scaffold if it moves unexpectedly, is struck, becomes unstable, or is exposed to conditions beyond its safe operating limits.

5. Responsibilities

Workers should check the scaffold status information required by the site, follow access restrictions, and report defects immediately. Supervisors should prevent use until serious defects are corrected.

Only authorized personnel should alter scaffold components. Never remove a brace, tie, guardrail, or platform component to make a task easier.

6. Questions this document can answer

Who should erect or alter scaffolds? Trained and authorized personnel.

Who checks a scaffold before use? A competent person, following applicable site and legal requirements.

What is the maximum height before a guardrail is mandatory? This sample does not specify a universal height; consult the governing rules.

End of document.